Clout City: Hollywood Music — World State Layer Brief (v1)

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1. Context

The World State layer is the same day-one system as in Clout City: NYC. Every story beat writes to it and every game system reads from it. **Port Clout City's World State module as-is**; this brief lists what changes for Hollywood Music and adds the music-specific effects, tags and protected systems.

Clout City: Hollywood Music is a satirical music-career life game: a player arrives in Echo Flats, plays shows as a rhythm game, builds a band, grows fame and fans, and climbs from a café open mic toward a stadium. Stories are the main retention driver, and the town should react to them: NPCs gossip, shows get cancelled, venues pack with fans, a diss track turns up in everyone's setlist.

The first story is "Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?": a 10-beat Echo Flats mystery with three predictions and three premium side arcs. It is the layer's acceptance test. The schema must support every future arc, so nothing is shaped around this one story.

First step: inspect the Hollywood Music repo and the ported Clout City modules, and report where each system integrates before building. Stack: Next.js, Supabase, Stripe and Vercel.

Related documents: Clarifications & Updates (rules and P1 scope), Story Quality Brief (content rules), Design System Guide (UI), New Features Spec (hunts, news, Story Studio, song pipeline).

2. Principles

All eight Clout City principles hold, with fame in place of clout.

1. **Data-driven:** arcs, beats, predictions, effects, chatter, story tasks and story songs live in data files.
2. **Derived, not mutated:** global world state is a pure function of (arc definitions, world clock). Only per-player progress is stored.
3. **Tag-based targeting:** places, venues, show slots, events, shop items, songs, tasks and NPC types carry tags (`the_marquee`, `venue`, `rusty_amp`, `instruments`, `story_song`). Effects target tags, optionally scoped to a district.

4. **Expiring effects:** every effect ends by expiry or a later beat.
5. **Fail-safe defaults:** anything missing or unmatched behaves as if there were no world state.
6. **Progression-safe:** effects never block protected systems (section 7).
7. **Explainable:** every changed price, closure or cancelled show returns reason text for the reason banner ("Show cancelled: venue double-booked").
8. **Rewards come from base values, and skill is untouchable:** price effects change only what a player pays; nothing in this layer changes how a show is scored, its stars, or the fans and fame it pays.

3. Data model

The arc, beat and prediction objects are unchanged from Clout City (fields `id`, `title`, `type` main / side / hunt, `parent_arc_id`, `tier`, `sku`, `status`, `start_at`, `start_weekday`, `district_scope` (was `borough_scope`), `teaser`, `answer_key`, `beats[]`; beats with `day`, `status`, `visible_at`, `effective_at`, `news[]`, `effects[]`, `story_tasks[]`, `prediction`, `requires`, `points_at_answer`; predictions with `closes_at`, `reveal_beat`, `correct`, `reward`, `changeable`).

Effect types

The seven Clout City effect types stay; two music effects are added.

Type	Purpose	Midnight Saints example
`price_multiplier`	Changes a price by tag; `applies_to`: `visit_price` (including "Watch a show"), `event_entry`, `shop_price` or `rehearsal_fee`	"Watch a show" at The Rusty Amp ×1.5, Days 2 to 5
`availability`	Close, restrict, cancel or open entities by tag, with reason text	The Marquee restricted to "lobby only" on Day 1
`chatter_topic`	Activates a gossip topic and phase	`midnight-saints`, phase `early`
`task_injection`	Adds or removes story tasks or story deals	`story:midnight-saints:watch-the-popup`
`place_state`	Changes how a place looks, or spawns a place or event	A fan protest outside The Marquee; a free pop-up show at The Rusty Amp

Type	Purpose	Midnight Saints example
`flag`	Sets a world flag for `requires`	`saints-solved`
`reward_modifier`	Adjusts fame for tagged tasks; never purchases, side arcs or shows	—
`show_slot` (new)	Cancels, adds or delays a venue's player show slot for a day, with reason text. A cancelled slot is never the player's only paid venue that day (validation)	The Marquee's slot cancelled on Day 7: "Show cancelled: venue double-booked"
`song_injection` (new)	Adds a story song to every eligible player's setlist for a window, at the venues and difficulties listed; players who play it in the window keep it	"Page Fourteen" playable at Bar and Club, Days 7 to 10

Story songs

A story song is a normal song record (audio stems, one chart per difficulty, tags including `story_song` and the arc id) produced through the song pipeline (New Features Spec). It is only listed while a `song_injection` is active. It pays like any song; it never changes scoring.

State

World state (computed): world time, active arcs, active effects, flags, open and closed predictions, injected songs, cancelled or added show slots.

Player state (stored): beats seen, story tasks done, votes, shadow guesses, hunt progress, badges, entitlements, and kept story songs.

4. Query API and resolution rules

All Clout City functions stay (`getModifiers` , `isAvailable` , `getPrice` , `getFame` (was `getClout`), `getChatter` , `getStoryTasks` , `getNewsFeed` , `getPredictions` , `hasEntitlement`). Two are added.

Function	Returns
`getShowSlot(venue, player, day)`	`{open, opens_at, reason}`: the player's paid slot at that venue today, after any `show_slot` effect
`getSetlist(player, venue)`	The songs this player can play at this venue's difficulty: unlocked songs, kept story songs, and any song injected right now

Stacking rules are unchanged (highest price multiplier, capped at 2×; closures override; at most 2 chatter topics; protected systems ignored; paused arcs contribute nothing), plus: a `show_slot` cancel overrides an add on the same venue and day.

5. Story timing

Unchanged from Clout City: one story day equals one real New York calendar day on a server-authoritative clock; main arcs of 6 to 10 beats; never two finales on one day; `start_weekday` (Sunday for the pilot); late joiners read every released beat and vote in open predictions; finished arcs move to the archive with shadow guesses; the pilot's start is set manually in the Story Studio; pause and retire are data edits. The time-travel control and debug panel are required, and the debug panel adds injected songs and show-slot changes.

6. NPC chatter

Unchanged structure: four phases (early, mid, late, post), 2 to 3 lines per NPC type per topic per phase, generic fallback, no answer-hinting line before its prediction closes. Hollywood NPC types: barista, bartender, sound guy, bouncer, valet, guitar-shop clerk, busker, rideshare driver, film extra.

7. Story tasks, places and progression safety

Story tasks are tagged `story:<arc_id>:<task>`, earn fame and can count toward daily tasks. Allowed actions: visit a place, watch a show at a venue, play a show at a venue, play a story song, attend an event, share a beat, vote, open an evidence card, buy a Shop item, rehearse with your band.

Places, venues and events: effects can spawn, change, restrict or cancel them, including free story events and show slots, always with reason text. Fame cooldowns are never reset by stories.

Protected systems (effects never apply):

- Onboarding, the tutorial and the first open mic.
- **Show scoring:** timing windows, points, multiplier, Hype, the Crowd meter, stars, fans, fame and pay from a show.
- **Practice, calibration and rehearsal results.**
- **Bandmates:** hiring, Chemistry and quitting are per-player and never driven by shared stories.
- **Venue unlocks by fame tier** (Clout City's borough unlock flow).
- Sign-up, log-in, all purchase flows, bills, rent and band pay.

Daily tasks only pick venues with an open slot and places that are open and off cooldown, so a story never makes a task impossible.

8. Premium content, entitlements and payments

Unchanged from Clout City: the main arc is always free; side arcs ($2.99), exclusive events, collector items and monument postcards are all gated by `hasEntitlement(player, sku)`; Stripe Checkout with an idempotent webhook as the only grant; `charge.refunded` revokes; prices in Stripe and config. Side arcs are personal-layer only, add no fame, give no edge in predictions, and are never touched by `reward_modifier` or `song_injection`.

Never sell: the ending or reveal, influence in polls, information pointing at an open prediction, story songs, or anything that affects a show.

9. Example data

An excerpt of the pilot (3 of 10 beats). The full arc follows the Story Quality Brief's blueprint for "Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?"; `start_at` is a placeholder Sunday.

```
{
  "id": "midnight-saints",
  "title": "Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?",
  "type": "main",
  "tier": "free",
  "status": "active",
  "start_at": "2026-11-08",
  "start_weekday": "sunday",
  "district_scope": ["echo_flats"],
  "answer_key": { "sent_the_email": "moss-delaney", "server_only": true },
  "beats": [
    {
      "id": "ms-1",
```

```
      "day": 1,
      "status": "active",
      "news": [{ "headline": "Saints' Big Night Cancelled by Email",
"previously": null }],
      "effects": [
        { "type": "chatter_topic", "topic": "midnight-saints", "phase":
"early", "priority": 2 },
        { "type": "place_state", "tags": ["the_marquee"], "state":
"fan_protest", "reason": "Fans demanding answers", "expires_day": 3 },
        { "type": "task_injection", "add": ["story:midnight-saints:watch-at-
the-marquee"] }
      ]
    },
    {
      "id": "ms-3",
      "day": 3,
      "status": "active",
      "news": [{ "headline": "Page Fourteen", "previously": "Someone emailed
The Marquee from the lawyer's account at 2:14 AM. Marty says it wasn't him."
}],
      "effects": [
        { "type": "price_multiplier", "tags": ["rusty_amp"], "applies_to":
"visit_price", "multiplier": 1.5, "reason": "Saints fans packing the bar",
"expires_day": 6 }
      ],
      "prediction": {
        "id": "P1",
        "question": "Who sent the cancellation email?",
        "options": ["Marty Vance", "Kiki Moon", "Jolene Vega", "Moss
Delaney"],
        "closes_at": { "day": 6, "time": "23:59" },
        "reveal_beat": "ms-9",
        "correct": "Moss Delaney",
        "reward": { "fame": 80, "badge": "called-it" },
        "changeable": true
      }
    },
    {
      "id": "ms-7",
      "day": 7,
      "status": "active",
      "points_at_answer": true,
      "news": [{ "headline": "The Show Must Go On (At a Dive Bar)",
"previously": "Jolene has a secret solo offer, and the contract's Page
Fourteen is real." }],
      "effects": [
```

```
        { "type": "show_slot", "tags": ["the_marquee"], "action": "cancel",
"reason": "Show cancelled: venue double-booked", "expires_day": 8 },
        { "type": "place_state", "tags": ["rusty_amp"], "spawn_event":
"saints-popup", "event_type": "free_story", "expires_day": 8 },
        { "type": "song_injection", "song": "page-fourteen", "difficulties":
["bar", "club"], "expires_day": 10 },
        { "type": "chatter_topic", "topic": "midnight-saints", "phase":
"late", "priority": 2 }
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

Validation rejects P1 if `closes_at` is later than the start of `ms-7`, which is flagged `points_at_answer`.

10. Build sequence and deliverables

The same three stages as Clout City, all before launch: **foundation** (port the module, tags, clock, time travel, debug panel, News feed, chatter, price and availability hooks), **story mechanics** (closures, `place_state`, `show_slot`, `song_injection`, story tasks, predictions, the pilot as data), **premium** (entitlements, Stripe, refunds, the three side arcs).

Deliverables: an integration report; the ported module with the two new effects; the pilot and side arcs as data; dev tools; the validation script (Clout City's checks plus: every injected song exists with charts for its listed difficulties, no cancelled slot leaves a player with no open paid venue that day, no effect targets a protected system); unit tests (Clout City's plus show-slot cancel and add, song injection and keeping, and proof that no effect changes show scoring); a one-page "how to add a new arc" guide.

Acceptance: with time travel in staging, every pilot beat, effect, show-slot change, injected song, chatter phase, prediction window and side-arc unlock fires on the right day; a test purchase unlocks a side arc, a replayed webhook doesn't duplicate it, and a refund revokes it.

11. Content rules

As in Clout City, in full in the Story Quality Brief: fictional characters, bands, labels, venues and brands only; no real artists, songs or companies; serious subjects off-screen and non-graphic; satire aimed at personalities, never at groups, faith or grief; narrated by Lola Lowdown, "Hollywood's most reliable unreliable source."